

RBIM — Relationship Boundary Integrity Module

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Architecture Ecosystem: Structured Reality Standards™

Architecture Family: Accountability Governance Architecture (AGA™)

Operational Layer: Relationship Governance Layer

Category: Governance & Enforcement

Subcategory: Accountability Governance Architecture

Type: Relationship Accountability Standard Module

Parent Standard: Relationship Accountability Standard (RAS)

Version: 1.0

Status: Canonical · Open Module

Origin Date: 14 June 2026

Compatibility: Accountability Governance Architecture (AGA™) ·

Relationship Accountability Standard (RAS) · Authority

Governance Standard (AGS) · Responsibility Governance Standard (RGS)

· Chain of Control Standard (CCS)

AI-Readable: Yes

Authority: OOF

Protection: MIP — Methodological Intellectual Property

Canonical Language: English (UCL)

Canonical Definition

Relationship Boundary Integrity Module (RBIM) defines the structural conditions under which the boundaries, limits, scope, and governance extent of relationships remain identifiable, distinguishable, traceable, governable, and operationally valid throughout the relationship lifecycle.

RBIM governs relationship boundaries.

The module establishes the conditions required to determine where a relationship begins, where it ends, what it includes, what it excludes, and how far governance obligations extend across participating actors.

Module Operational Role

RBIM serves as the boundary-governance layer of the Relationship Accountability Standard.

Its role is to define the limits of relationships before authority, responsibility, capability, control, oversight, evidence, and accountability analysis proceeds.

RBIM answers the question:

Where do the boundaries of the relationship begin and end?

Module Operational Space

RBIM governs:

- relationship boundaries
- relationship scope
- governance boundaries
- operational limits
- participation limits
- inclusion criteria
- exclusion criteria
- boundary traceability

The module applies wherever governance requires clear relationship limits.

Module Function

The module ensures that governance can determine:

- who is inside the relationship
- who is outside the relationship
- what activities are covered
- what activities are excluded
- where governance obligations start
- where governance obligations stop
- where relationship influence begins
- where relationship influence ends

Its function is to prevent governance ambiguity caused by unclear relationship boundaries.

Minimum Implementation Framework

1. Define Relationship Scope

Determine the intended scope of the relationship.

Examples:

- employment relationship
- contractor relationship
- supplier relationship
- supervisory relationship
- Human-AI relationship
- multi-agent relationship

2. Identify Included Actors

Identify all actors operating within the relationship boundary.

Examples:

- individuals
- organizations
- contractors
- subcontractors
- AI agents
- robotic systems

3. Identify Excluded Actors

Determine which actors remain outside the relationship boundary.

Governance must distinguish between:

- participating actors
- non-participating actors
- indirect actors
- external actors

4. Validate Boundary Accuracy

Determine whether documented boundaries reflect operational reality.

Governance must identify:

- hidden extensions
- undeclared participation
- informal influence
- boundary expansion
- boundary contraction

5. Preserve Boundary Traceability

Maintain sufficient evidence to reconstruct relationship boundaries throughout governance analysis.

Use Case 1 — Multi-Layer Contractor Environment

Scenario

A company contracts a supplier, who contracts a subcontractor, who contracts a staffing agency.

Application

RBIM determines which actors fall within the operational relationship boundary and where governance obligations extend.

Result

Governance gains a clear understanding of relationship limits across the operational chain.

Use Case 2 — Human-AI Operational Environment

Scenario

A human operator supervises an orchestration system controlling multiple AI agents and robotic systems.

Application

RBIM determines the governance boundaries of participation, supervision, and operational influence.

Result

Governance gains visibility into the limits of the operational relationship structure.

Canonical Closing Statement

Relationship Boundary Integrity Module (RBIM) defines the structural conditions under which the boundaries, limits, scope, and governance extent of relationships remain identifiable, distinguishable, traceable, governable, and operationally valid throughout the relationship lifecycle.

Governance cannot determine obligations if relationship boundaries remain unclear. Relationship boundary integrity therefore becomes a foundational condition of accountability governance.

Related Documents

→ [Relationship Accountability Standard - \(RAS\)](#).

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